SF Tech Week 2026: Attendance Plan

SpringBrand (springbrand.ai) | Oct 5-11, 2026, San Francisco | Prepared by Arsham, Growth Marketing

Summary

- **Objective:** meet as many qualified potential customers, partners and referral sources as possible, build SpringBrand brand awareness (photos, social content, recognizable companies), and come back with a deeper understanding of the AI agent and AI GTM market.
- **Method:** I reviewed the full official SF Tech Week calendar (about 1,700 SF events, snapshot of Sep 30) against my initial plan, kept the strongest events, fixed schedule conflicts, and added events where our core buyers (founders who own GTM, GTM engineers, growth marketers, and agent builders) will be concentrated.
- **Result:** about 4-5 focused events per day instead of overlapping full-day commitments, with dedicated follow-up blocks so conversations turn into pipeline during the week, not after it.

What changed from the initial plan

- **More time with our buyers.** Added GTM-focused events (Clay demos, Founders Who Inherited Marketing, GTM Engineering founder demos, AMA marketing, AI & the Future of Marketing). The initial plan had only 3-4 events aimed at GTM buyers.
- **Added Anthropic's Claude Founder House** (Tue-Thu). SpringBrand runs inside Claude Code, so founders building on Claude are our easiest audience and the best brand/photo opportunity of the week.
- **Resolved overlaps.** Wednesday had four overlapping commitments (Leverage IL all day, Adobe, Tool Evaluations, Stripe Supper Club). Leverage IL is now morning only, with clear either/or choices in the evening. Tuesday's Google event is shortened so I can make Founder-led Sales Night.
- **Repositioned Sunday's hackathon.** Instead of 8 hours building, I attend the final demos and judging and (if approved) offer SpringBrand credits to participating teams, putting our tools into ~100 builders' hands.
- **Added follow-up blocks** on Tuesday, Friday and Saturday so LinkedIn connections, notes and demo bookings happen the same day.

Decisions needed from you

#	Decision	Detail	My recommendation
1	**Clay Sculpt conference (Thu Oct 8)**	Clay's GTM conference at Pier 48, 9am-5pm, $600 ticket. Not part of Tech Week; date is from a third-party listing and should be confirmed on sculpt.clay.com.	Attend if budget allows. It is the densest room of our target buyers (GTM engineers, RevOps, growth marketers) all week. It would replace the Thursday daytime events.
2	**Hackathon credits (Sun Oct 11)**	Offer free SpringBrand starter credits to every team at the Shopping 3.0 AI Commerce Hackathon (Arcade AI, ~100 participants).	Approve. Low cost, high-visibility distribution to builders, and a natural QR/referral moment.
3	**QR / referral offer**	Confirm what the event QR code links to and the starter-credit amount I can promise in person.	One Tech Week landing page with a tracked link so we can measure leads from the week.

Day-by-day schedule

Goal key: **C** = customers, **P** = partners / referral sources, **B** = brand awareness & photos, **L** = learning. Green rows are new or changed versus the initial plan. Times are start times from the official calendar; most events require host approval, and applications have been or are being submitted.

MONDAY, OCT 5: Agent infrastructure and GTM (all in FiDi)

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
1:00 PM	**The Integration Layer for AI Agents (Open Future Forum, Agentic Fabriq)**	FiDi	P, L	Agent builders working on MCP, connectors and tool access, the layer SpringBrand sits in. Future partners and the vocabulary technical buyers use.
4:00 PM	**Architecting AI-Native GTM (Amdahl)**	FiDi	C, L	Teams rebuilding GTM around AI agents: our core buyer profile.
6:00 PM	**Demos After Dark w/ Fin & Clay**	FiDi	C, P	Clay is the leading AI GTM data platform; its users (GTM engineers) build the lead-gen and account-research workflows SpringBrand powers.
Alt 6:00 PM	**Official Tech Week Kickoff (Fireworks x a16z, Vercel, ElevenLabs, Stripe)**	Mission Bay	B	Alternative if brand photos are the priority on day one: the week's biggest opening event.

TUESDAY, OCT 6: Anthropic, founders and sales

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
9:30 AM	**Claude Founder House (Anthropic)**	SOMA	B, C, P	SpringBrand runs inside Claude Code; founders building on Claude can adopt us immediately. Strongest brand/photo opportunity of the week.
12:00 PM	**Founder Lunch Club w/ Fin & Stripe**	Dogpatch	C	Small founder tables; early-stage founders still doing GTM research by hand. Featured event.
1:30 PM	**Follow-up block**			LinkedIn connections, notes and social posts from the morning.
4:00 PM	**Google for Startups x Google DeepMind: Panel, Happy Hour & Demo Slam**	SOMA	B, L	Recognizable brands and AI startup demos. Shortened to 4:00-5:30 to avoid conflicting with the evening event.
6:00 PM	**Founder-led Sales Night (Grok Bot x Stage2 Capital)**	North Beach	C, P	Founders doing their own sales need prospect research, our best use case. Stage2 Capital is a GTM-focused VC that can refer portfolio companies.
Backup 6:30 PM	**Running GTM with Agents (Cura, Lightfield)**	Exploratorium	C	Exactly our use case; backup if waitlisted for Founder-led Sales Night.

WEDNESDAY, OCT 7: Biggest GTM day of the week

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
9:00 AM	**Leverage IL (if admitted)**	The Hibernia	B, L	Speakers from Anthropic, Cognition, Google DeepMind and Greylock. Morning keynotes only; afternoon themes (cyber, defense) are less relevant.
Alt 11:00 AM	**Apollo: Find Your Next 100 Customers**	FiDi	C, L	If not admitted to Leverage IL: founders focused on prospecting; insight into a major adjacent company.
12:00 PM	**Founder Lunch: Founders Who Inherited Marketing (Andyama)**	Jackson Square	C	Founders who own marketing without a team need SEO, social listening and research done for them. Likely the most on-target event of the week.
3:00 PM	**GTM Engineering Leaders & Startups: Founder Demos (Twill)**	Union Square	C, L	GTM engineers run Clay-style workflows and understand SpringBrand's value immediately.
4:00 PM	**Adobe Presents: The GTM Inflection Point**	Design District	B, L	Adobe's VP of Digital GTM and Topaz Labs' CEO on how GTM changes as companies scale. Recognizable brand.
5:30 PM	**AI Tool Evaluations (AICamp, ScaleKit, Workato)**	Dogpatch	L, C	How teams decide to build vs. buy AI tools: the main objection we hear.
OR 6:00 PM	**Stripe x a16z B2B AI Supper Club (invite-only)**	SOMA	P, B	Takes priority over everything from 5:30 if invited: seated dinner with B2B AI founders and a16z.
Optional 6:00 PM	**Agent-Led Growth Night (2027.dev)**	Downtown	C	The event's theme is SpringBrand's pitch.

THURSDAY, OCT 8: Enterprise buying, marketers and investors

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
9:00 AM	**CxO Roundtable: How Enterprise Really Buys AI (a16z speedrun)**	Jackson Square	L, P	What moves AI from pilot to purchase; access to a16z speedrun founders.
3:00 PM	**Marketing in the AI Era (AMA SF x Quantcast)**	SOMA	C, L	A room of marketers: peers and potential buyers. Good test audience for our non-technical pitch.
4:30 PM	**Fenwick x Databricks x a16z: Founders & Investors Happy Hour**	FiDi	B, P	Featured event with major brands; investors can refer portfolio companies.
Alt 4:30 PM	**Agents & Integrations Night (Nebius, Adyen, APIMatic)**	SOMA	P	Alternative for meeting API and integration companies as potential partners.
Option	**Clay Sculpt conference ($600, pending approval)**	Pier 48	C, P, L	See Decision #1. Would replace the Thursday daytime events.

FRIDAY, OCT 9: Agent data companies and the finale

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
10:30 AM	**a16z speedrun AI Faire**	Jackson Square	C, B	High volume of AI startups in one place; fast qualification.
12:00 PM	**The Tech Week Flyover (Sentry, Exa, Neon)**	SOMA	P	Exa provides web search for AI agents and sells to the same agent builders we do: a natural partner.
Alt 12:00 PM	**World of Tavily**	TBD	P	Exa's closest competitor, launching a startup program with GTM opportunities. Pick one of the two.
1:30 PM	**Follow-up block**			Mid-week follow-ups, demo bookings and posting.
7:00 PM	**AI & The Future of Marketing**	Union Square	C, L	Marketers in person; our growth-marketing angle.
8:30 PM	**a16z x Unicorner x Notion: Official Afterparty**	Lower Nob Hill	B	The week's closing event; best photo and visibility opportunity.

SATURDAY, OCT 10: Reset

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
All day	**Follow-up and content day**			Follow up on every Wed-Fri conversation, publish a Tech Week recap post, and book demos for the following week.

SUNDAY, OCT 11: AI commerce

Time	Event (host)	Location	Goal	Why it matters for SpringBrand
~3:30 PM	**Shopping 3.0: AI Commerce Hackathon (Arcade AI): final demos & judging**	Union Square	B, P	Judges include Kirsten Green (Forerunner Ventures) and Mariam Naficy. Attend demos rather than building all day; offer team credits if approved (Decision #2).

How I will work each event

- **Open with their work, not our features:** "What are you building, and which parts of your GTM are still manual?"
- **Qualify fast:** strong fit = recurring GTM research + need for external data + multiple tools + manual work today.
- **Bridge in one sentence:** "SpringBrand lets your AI agent pull live lead lists, competitor SEO and social conversations, pay per call, usually under a cent, with no subscription."
- **Capture every good conversation:** name, company, role, pain point, current solution, use case, next step. LinkedIn request sent the same day, referencing the conversation.
- **Content:** photos and short posts from Featured events (Anthropic, Google DeepMind, Adobe, a16z) for LinkedIn and X during the week.

Daily targets and how I will report

Metric	Daily target	Week target (Mon-Fri)
Meaningful conversations	**10-15**	50-75
Qualified prospects	**5+**	25+
Relevant LinkedIn connections	**10+**	50+
Follow-up / demo opportunities	**2-3**	10-15
Buyer-pain insights captured	**1+**	5+

I will send a short daily recap each evening (conversations, qualified leads, next steps) and a full Tech Week summary with pipeline and learnings on Monday, Oct 12.

After the week

- **Within 24 hours:** personalized follow-up to every qualified contact, referencing our conversation.
- **Within 1 week:** book demos with interested prospects and share a free sample built for their workflow.
- **Partners:** follow up separately with partner candidates (agent infrastructure and data companies) about integrations or co-marketing.
- **Learning:** short internal write-up of buyer pain points and market trends heard during the week.

Notes: Event times come from the official SF Tech Week calendar (tech-week.com/calendar/sf) as of Sep 30, 2026; end times are not published for most events. Leverage IL is listed on Luma rather than the official calendar. Clay Sculpt's date and price come from a third-party listing and should be confirmed on sculpt.clay.com. Attendance at most events depends on host approval.